

# Checkpoints & interrupted travel

CONFLICT / EDITION 2026-10-02

**QUICK ANSWER / START HERE**

Avoid unnecessary travel through active fighting or uncertain checkpoints. Check the route and requirements as recently as possible, keep identification and essential medical information accessible, and avoid confrontation. A uniform, posted order or claimed safe corridor does not guarantee safe passage. Rules and protection risks differ by place.

## Do now.

- ☐ **Decide whether travel is necessary**  
01 Compare the danger of staying with the risks of the route. Do not travel only to investigate a closure. Have a known destination and another option.
- ☐ **Verify current conditions**  
02 Compare recent trusted local information with independently verified humanitarian information. Check dates and exact locations; old route advice may be unsafe.
- ☐ **Keep essential documents accessible**  
03 Carry identification and medical information securely. Know where they are so you do not need a hurried search. Do not display sensitive details unnecessarily.
- ☐ **Avoid escalating an encounter**  
04 Remain calm, avoid sudden gestures and do not film an encounter when doing so increases danger. There is no universal script that guarantees safe treatment.
- ☐ **Keep the household together**  
05 Have an agreed check-in and separation plan. Do not send a child or vulnerable person ahead alone to test a route.

# Keep the plan moving.

## IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

If nobody can verify a route and travel is not immediately necessary, remain in the safer available place while reassessing. Do not assume a public convoy or unofficial driver has secured protection.

## Watch for.

This is civilian safety planning, not advice to evade checkpoints or legal restrictions. Never assume passage based on a map, an insignia or an unverified promise.

## People & practical needs.

Assign a trusted adult to each person who needs assistance. Keep medicines, essential contacts and a workable reunion plan with the group. Make decisions around the least mobile person, not the fastest; avoid splitting the family without a clear, safe way to reconnect. For this situation, brief every person on the first action: decide whether travel is necessary. Agree who will manage children, pets or mobility needs while that action happens. This is civilian safety planning, not advice to evade checkpoints or legal restrictions. Never assume passage based on a map, an insignia or an unverified promise.

## Keep essentials within reach.

For checkpoints & interrupted travel, prioritize only items needed for the first action and the fallback: If nobody can verify a route and travel is not immediately necessary, remain in the safer available place while reassessing. Do not assume a public convoy or unofficial driver has secured protection. Keep the relevant checklist and contact information within reach. Equipment retrieval must not delay the protective step.

## Next decisions.

Where you face detention or abuse risk, seek trusted local legal or humanitarian protection advice before travel when possible. Keep a private record of events only when doing so is safe.

### First decision: Decide whether travel is necessary

Compare the danger of staying with the risks of the route. Do not travel only to investigate a closure. Have a known destination and another option. Decide which person can carry this out immediately and what would prevent it in your current location. Do not delay the protective step to complete a household worksheet.

### When the original plan fails

If nobody can verify a route and travel is not immediately necessary, remain in the safer available place while reassessing. Do not assume a public convoy or unofficial driver has secured protection. Reassess the next available location or resource using the warning signs in this guide; do not assume a promised service is operating.

## Before changing location

This is civilian safety planning, not advice to evade checkpoints or legal restrictions. Never assume passage based on a map, an insignia or an unverified promise. Check the actual route and the needs of the person who will have the most difficulty moving. A destination is not confirmed until access and conditions have been checked.

## Questions in the field.

### What matters before collecting supplies?

Avoid unnecessary travel through active fighting or uncertain checkpoints. Check the route and requirements as recently as possible, keep identification and essential medical information accessible, and avoid confrontation. A uniform, posted order or claimed safe corridor does not guarantee safe passage. Rules and protection risks differ by place. Collect items only if doing so does not delay this action.

### What should another household member do?

Use a second person to handle communication or dependents while the first carries out the immediate action. For checkpoints & interrupted travel, keep the specific hazard in view: This is civilian safety planning, not advice to evade checkpoints or legal restrictions. Never assume passage based on a map, an insignia or an unverified promise.

### What should be written down?

Record when the situation changed, what action was taken and what remains uncertain. For this situation, start with: Keep the household together. Have an agreed check-in and separation plan. Do not send a child or vulnerable person ahead alone to test a route. Keep personal notes private; they are not submitted to Osprey Zero.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

## Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

[UNHCR · Help for refugees and displaced people](#)

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<https://help.unhcr.org/>

ICRC · [Reconnecting families](#)

<https://www.icrc.org/en/what-we-do/reconnecting-families>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/checkpoint-safety/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.